

THE MOVE

Listen for overlap, name it specifically, avoid overclaiming, then invite the next practical step. -> It sounds like we both care about getting this handled cleanly. -> Different reasons, same concern about timing. -> We may not agree on the cause...

START HERE

It sounds like we both care about getting this handled cleanly.

SAY THIS

Quick openers	<i>"It sounds like we both want this to go well."</i>
Warmth and connecti...	<i>"It sounds like we both care about getting this handled cleanly."</i>
Work and decisions	<i>"It sounds like we're aligned on the timeline, even if the budget still needs a look."</i>
Naming the overlap	<i>"The overlap I hear is that neither of us wants this to get messier."</i>
Softening and repair	<i>"I don't want to pretend we see it the same way, but there is overlap in wanting a fair process."</i>
Digital / text	<i>"I may be reading this wrong, but that seems like the key thread."</i>

AVOID

- When common ground would minimise a real power difference or harm
- When the person needs their difference acknowledged before any overlap
- When the overlap would be fake, exaggerated, or self-serving

REMEMBER

Common ground must be discovered, not invented.